MATH INQUIRERS HOLIDAY PROGRAM

K2 Readiness Check

A 15-minute check for K2 children who want to join before starting Primary 1

Notice it. Test it. Explain why.

Why we check

Math Inquirers is built on the Primary 1 syllabus and goes beyond it. K2 children have not met P1 maths yet, so some will fly and some will feel lost. The check tells us who will enjoy the group, who needs a little support first, and who will get more from a later intake. It is short and friendly: children should feel they played some number games.

How to run it

- **Time:** about 15 minutes, one child at a time. Face to face, or on video with the parent setting out the counters.
- **You need:** about 25 counters (buttons or coins are fine), number cards 9, 14, 17 and 20, the child sheet (last page) and a pencil.
- **Parent:** may sit in, but asks them not to help or prompt. Online, the parent only moves objects when asked.
- **Tone:** say "Let's play some number games." Praise effort, not right answers. Never say "wrong"; say "Let's try another one."
- **Stop early** if the child is upset or has scored 0 on four items in a row. Note it and move to the decision.

Scoring

2 = correct, without help. **1** = correct with a hint, or slow (counting from 1, using fingers for everything). **0** = not yet, or no answer. Total out of 24.

Watch for these too

Behaviour	Yes / not yet
Stays with the task for 15 minutes with only small reminders	
Follows a two-step instruction ("Count out 7, then put them in two groups")	
Tries again when stuck instead of giving up	
Can hold a pencil and write numbers to 20	

Script and score sheet

Child's name: _____ Date: _____ Tutor: _____

#	Say or do	Look for (2 marks)	Score
1	Put about 25 counters in a pile. "Count out 17 for me."	Touches each one once, stops at 17.	0 1 2
2	Show number cards 9, 14, 17, 20. "Read these numbers."	Reads all four without counting up.	0 1 2
3	"Write 6, 12 and 19 in the boxes." (child sheet, part A)	Numerals formed correctly, not reversed (12 not 21).	0 1 2
4	"Count on from 8 to 15." Then: "Count back from 10 to 1."	Starts at 8 without going back to 1; counts back smoothly.	0 1 2
5	"Which is more, 13 or 18? How do you know?"	Says 18, and gives a reason ("18 comes after 13", "it has more ones").	0 1 2
6	"What is one more than 14? One less than 10?"	15 and 9 without counting from 1.	0 1 2
7	Give 7 counters. "Put them into two groups. Can you do it another way?"	Makes 7 in at least two different ways (e.g. 5 and 2, 4 and 3).	0 1 2
8	"I have 5 sweets and get 3 more. How many?" Then: "I have 9 and eat 4. How many left?"	8 and 5, with or without counters.	0 1 2
9	"Ali has 3 apples. Mei gives him 2 more. How many now? How did you work it out?"	Correct (5) and can say or show how.	0 1 2
10	Lay out red, red, blue, red, red, blue. "What comes next? And next?"	Red, red. Can say the rule ("two reds then a blue").	0 1 2
11	"2, 4, 6 … what comes next? And next?" (child sheet, part B)	8 and 10. Score 1 if counting by ones to get there.	0 1 2
12	Child sheet, part C: "Name these shapes. How many sides does the triangle have?"	Circle, triangle, square, rectangle; 3 sides.	0 1 2
		Total (out of 24)	

Decision

18–24	**Ready.** Joins any group like a Primary 1 child. Tell the tutor in the class list that the child is in K2 and keep an eye on Lessons 5 and 6 (working backwards and money), which are the biggest jump.
12–17	**Ready with support.** Joins, with three conditions: we send the K2 Starter Pack two weeks before the program (numbers to 20, writing numbers, number bonds to 10, coins); the child sits with a buddy; and the tutor sets Core questions first, with Think Harder only when Core is done.
0–11	**Not yet.** Recommend a later intake (the March or June holidays) and give the free home activity sheet. Say it positively: "Your child will get much more out of it after a term of Primary 1."

Override rules

- Score 0 on item 3 (writing numbers) → **Ready with support** at best, because the workbook needs writing.
- "Stays with the task" ticked "not yet" → recommend the online group with a parent nearby, or a later intake.
- Child scores 22+ and explains reasons well → note "strong", so the tutor offers Challenge questions early.

Telling the parent

Within a day, send a short message with the result band, one thing the child did well, and the next step. Sample for "Ready with support":

> *"Thank you for bringing Ethan for the number games today. He counted and compared numbers confidently and loved the pattern game. Primary 1 maths will be new to him, so we will send a short Starter Pack to try at home over the next two weeks, and he will start with the core questions in class. We think he will enjoy the program. His place in Group A is confirmed."*

If several K2 children sign up

If four or more K2 children register for the same period, consider a separate K2 group. Teach the same ten lessons with smaller numbers (to 20 instead of 100), more objects and fewer written questions. This can grow into a "Little Inquirers" K2 program later.

Number games

Name: _____

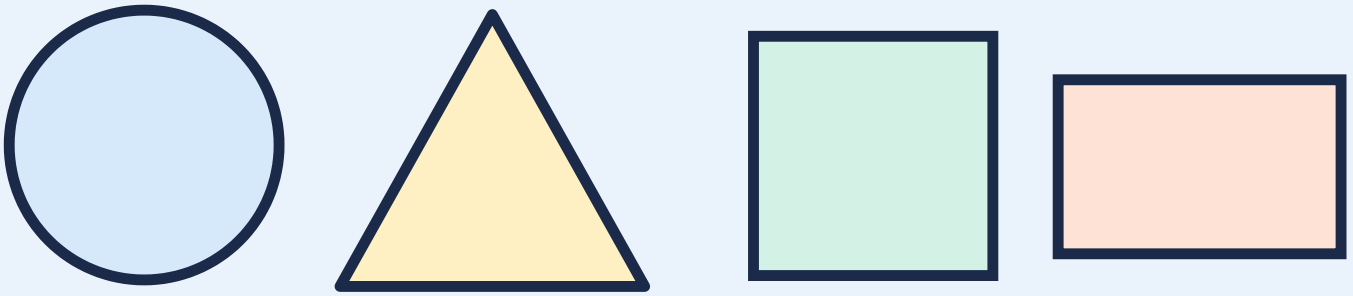
A. Write these numbers



B. What comes next?

2, 4, 6, 

C. Name the shapes



D. Draw what comes next

